

By keeping their goal in mind and being intentional about their financial decisions, Maggie and Tom hit their retirement goals in their fifties and topped it off by buying a vacation home in Florida, where they spend part of the year. When we asked Maggie what her advice was to someone who wants to do what they did, she simply said, “Decide what’s important to you and stick to it.” This couple, worth \$2 million, knew early on that their decisions had the power to take them closer to their dream or further away from it. They chose to *decide* their way into wealth, just like all the other millionaires we studied. Then, even though they had plenty of money, they maintained their wealth by doing the same simple, intentional things that got them there.

CHOOSING INTENTIONALITY

Intentionality comes down to two things: sacrifice and choices. You have to know what you’re willing to let go of. If I haven’t been clear in this chapter, let me break it down for you. You’ve got to let go of the stupid things that are stealing your potential—things like debt, inattention, and wandering aimlessly through life. Instead, you’ve got to take on millionaire behaviors—like living on less than you make, budgeting, and making active, intentional decisions about who you want to be and how you want to live. Being intentional gives you options. It opens the door to more choices than ever before, but it also demands some sacrifices—and some of those sacrifices will hurt.

If you’ve been walking around with your head in a fog, unplugged from the day-to-day reality of your life, then I’ve got a three-part plan that will wake you up and shake you out of your unmotivated stupor. I call it the Triple A Process for Improvement: assess, acknowledge, and activate:

1. *Assess your current situation.* Be honest about where you spend your time, money, and attention. Ask yourself if those investments are paying off for you. Are they taking you closer to or further from your goals? Don’t lie to yourself. Remember, millionaires are honest with themselves, even when faced with their own failure.